

August 27, 2026

Dear Delaware Valley Regional High School Community,

On November 3, 2026, you will be asked to vote on a referendum to fund a necessary fire alarm system replacement to protect the safety of students and staff. I would like to take this opportunity to provide you with information on this referendum designed to **update our fire alarm system without an increase in taxes for this project**. The current fire alarm system was installed 20 years ago and is approaching the end of its useful life. While the current alarm is still operational and safe, the maintenance of the system grows more frequent and more expensive each year and will soon become obsolete.

The **1-Year Referendum Cost-Saving Strategy** provides the district with access to Debt Service Aid. This is one way in which our community is able to recoup some of our tax dollars to benefit our schools, students, and taxpayers. The full cost of a new fire alarm system that meets New Jersey code is \$926,000. This includes the purchase, installation, as well as soft costs (fees, permits, etc.) and state-required contingencies. By supporting and passing this referendum, our district becomes eligible for **approximately \$314,840 in aid toward the total cost of this project**.

I would like to reiterate that this bond referendum will have no financial impact on taxpayers. An affirmative vote will reduce the cost to the district by an estimated 34% of the total cost of the project. The Board expects to fund the remaining local share of the project using our available capital reserve funds. Should the referendum not pass, the district would not be eligible for this state aid and be forced to fund this project at 100% using capital reserve funds, as this fire alarm system is essential to maintaining a safe school environment.

For additional information and answers to frequently asked questions, please [visit our district website](#). Please feel free to email our [School Business Administrator, Mrs. Teresa O'Brien](#), or [me](#) with any questions about this referendum project.

Thank you for your attention and ongoing support of the Delaware Valley Regional High School District. Please remember to vote on November 3rd!

Warm regards,

Scott McKinney, Superintendent
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